📝 CROSS-CURRICULAR LITERACY · YEAR 9–10

Water Safety Meets Media & Persuasion

A cross-curricular unit connecting HPE water safety content with English and Media literacy skills — analysing real campaigns and producing original persuasive communication.

Year 9–10 HPE + English | 5 lessons | Media analysis | Persuasive writing

VC2HP10P08 · VC2E9LY05 · VC2E9LY08

🏊 HPE Curriculum Codes

- VC2HP10P08 — Plan, rehearse and evaluate strategies (including first aid and CPR) for managing situations where their own or others' health, safety or wellbeing may be negatively impacted at home, school and in the community
- VC2HP10P09 — Evaluate health information and critically analyse community health strategies
- VC2HP10P02 — Investigate how health behaviours influence outcomes for diverse groups

📚 English Curriculum Links

- VC2E9LY05 / VC2E10LY05 — Analyse and evaluate the ways that language features and text structures are used to represent perspectives, shape meaning and influence readers
- VC2E9LY08 / VC2E10LY08 — Create different types of texts, written and spoken, for a range of purposes, audiences and contexts, using deliberate language choices and multimodal elements
- VC2E9LY05 / VC2E9LA02 — Evaluate the reliability and currency of sources, and identify bias and perspective using knowledge of how language of evaluation and substantiation expresses views and values
- VC2E9LY08 / VC2E9LA03 — Use multimodal elements to create meaning in digital and print texts, adapting text structures and language features according to purpose

📋 Unit Overview — What, Why, and How

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

What you will ANALYSE

- Real LSV, SLSA, and RLSS UK campaigns
- Persuasive techniques in health communication
- Target audience identification and profiling
- Visual language, colour, and layout choices
- Fear appeal vs reframing vs social proof

What you will PRODUCE

- A campaign analysis report (2 campaigns)
- An original water safety campaign product
- A written justification of design choices
- A reflection on audience, purpose, and context

Why it matters

- Health communication is a real professional skill
- Understanding persuasion makes you harder to manipulate
- This connects HPE evidence to real-world change
- Applicable to VCE Health & Human Development
- Useful in English, Media, and VCAL pathways

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

1 Persuasion, Purpose & Audience — How Health Campaigns Work

⏱ 50 min | VC2HP10P09 · VC2E9LY05 · VC2E9LA03 | Individual + Class

Before you can create an effective water safety campaign, you need to understand how health campaigns work and why some succeed while others fail.

THE AAPPC FRAMEWORK — USE THIS FOR EVERY CAMPAIGN YOU ANALYSE

A — Audience

Who is this campaign targeting? How do you know? What assumptions does it make about its audience?

A — Aim / Purpose

What does the campaign want the audience to KNOW, THINK, or DO? Which of these is primary?

P — Persuasion Technique

Fear appeal? Social proof? Reframing? Authority? Emotional appeal? Narrative? Evidence?

P — Platform / Form

What medium is it using? Social media, poster, video, radio? Why this medium for this audience?

C — Credibility

Who produced it? What evidence or authority backs the message? Is it cited?

Critique

What does it do well? What limitation or gap does it have? Who might it NOT reach?

Activity 1.1 — Three Persuasion Techniques

3 marks

For each persuasion technique below, write a brief explanation and give an example from advertising or public health you have seen:

Technique	What it is and how it works	Example from real life (your own)
Fear appeal		
Reframing		
Social proof		

Activity 1.2 — Why Do Campaigns Fail?

2 marks

Research shows that fear appeals targeted at young males are often ineffective or can backfire. Using your knowledge of social determinants from the HPE unit, explain WHY this might be, and suggest a more effective alternative approach.

2 Analysing Real Campaigns — LSV, SLSA & RLSS UK

⏱ 50 min | VC2HP10P09 · VC2E9LY05 | Pairs + Devices

Visit the campaigns below and analyse two of them using the AAPPC framework from Lesson 1.

LIFE SAVING VICTORIA

SwimSafe & Community Campaigns

LSV runs multiple targeted campaigns including multilingual CALD resources and seasonal beach safety campaigns.

`lsv.com.au/community`

SURF LIFE SAVING AUSTRALIA

Choose Your Surf Campaign

SLSA campaigns targeting beachgoers about patrolled vs unpatrolled swimming choices.

`sls.com.au/surf-safety`

RLSS UK

Float to Live Campaign

The UK's flagship water safety campaign. Simple core message: if you fall into cold water, float first — don't swim immediately.

`rlss.org.uk/float-to-live`

Activity 2.1 — AAPPC Analysis: Campaign 1

6 marks

Campaign name and URL:

AAPPC Element	Your Analysis
Audience	
Aim / Purpose	
Persuasion Technique	
Platform / Form	
Credibility	
Critique (strengths & limitations)	

Activity 2.2 — AAPPC Analysis: Campaign 2

6 marks

Campaign name and URL (choose a different campaign from Activity 2.1):

AAPPC Element	Your Analysis

Audience	
Aim / Purpose	
Persuasion Technique	
Platform / Form	
Credibility	
Critique (strengths & limitations)	

Activity 2.3 — Comparative Evaluation

4 marks

Compare the two campaigns you analysed. Which is more effective, and why? Your comparison should address: target audience clarity, persuasion technique appropriateness, evidence backing, and reach limitations.

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

3 Visual Language & Multimodal Design

⏱ 50 min | VC2E9LY08 · VC2HP10P08 | Individual

Effective health communication uses visual, linguistic, and spatial elements together — this is called multimodal communication. Understanding how these elements work gives you more power as both a consumer and creator of health messaging.

VISUAL LANGUAGE TOOLKIT — APPLY TO CAMPAIGNS YOU ANALYSE

Colour psychology

Blue = trust, calm, water. Red = danger, urgency. Green = safety, go. Yellow = caution, energy. How do campaigns use colour to prime an emotional response before reading a word?

Typography

Font weight (bold = authority), font size (hierarchy of importance), font style (serif = tradition/trust, sans-serif = modern/accessible). Capitalisation for urgency.

Image selection

Who is shown? Who is NOT shown? What activities and emotions are depicted? Whose perspective is centred? Who is the victim vs the hero?

Spatial composition

Where is the eye led? What is given most visual weight? What is small or marginalised? What is the call to action and where is it placed?

Activity 3.1 — Visual Analysis of One Campaign

5 marks

Choose ONE of the campaigns from Lesson 2. Analyse its visual design using the toolkit above. Focus on how the visual choices work together to target and persuade the specific audience.

Campaign chosen: _____

Colour choices and what they communicate: _____

_____

Typography choices and what they signal: _____

Image selection — who/what is shown and why: _____

_____

Spatial composition — how does the design guide the eye and where is the call to action: ___

Overall: do the visual choices align well with the intended audience? What would you change and why?

Activity 3.2 — Representation & Inclusion

3 marks

Review the three campaigns from Lesson 2. For each, note whether CALD community members, people with disabilities, and diverse age groups appear to be represented as the intended audience — or whether the campaign implicitly targets a default (young, white, able-bodied) viewer. What are the implications of any gaps you find?

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

4 Planning Your Original Campaign

⏱ 50 min | VC2HP10P08 · VC2E9LY08 | Individual

You will now design an original water safety campaign for a specific Victorian at-risk group. Use everything you have learned in both HPE (data, social determinants) and English/Media (AAPPC, visual language).

Campaign Brief — Complete All Fields Before Designing

Planning

Campaign name:

_____

Target audience (be specific — age, gender, context, cultural background):

_____

_____

Platform (Instagram, TikTok, A3 poster, school newsletter, video, other):

_____

Primary persuasion technique I will use:

_____

Why this technique suits this audience (evidence):

_____

_____

Key message — ONE sentence (what do I want them to DO?):

_____

Victorian statistic I will use (with source URL):

_____

How my campaign will be different from the LSV / SLSA campaigns I analysed:

_____

_____

Sketch / describe your campaign visual concept:

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

Activity 4.1 — Peer Brief Review

2 marks

Exchange your campaign brief with a partner. Give them written feedback on TWO things: (1) whether the target audience and persuasion technique are well-matched based on what you learned in Lessons 1–3, and (2) one specific suggestion to strengthen the campaign.

Reviewer's name: _____

Feedback point 1 — audience/technique match:

_____

_____

Feedback point 2 — suggestion for improvement:

_____

_____

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

5 Creating, Presenting & Justifying Your Campaign

⏱ 50 min + extended time | VC2HP10P08 · VC2E9LY08 · VC2E10LY08 | Individual · Assessment

Produce your final campaign product and written justification. Together these demonstrate both your media literacy and your health communication skills.

Final Product — Campaign + Written Justification

Assessment task

Part A — Campaign Product: Produce your campaign (physical poster, Canva design, scripted video, social media post sequence, or other agreed format). Attach or present alongside this page.

Part B — Written Justification (200–300 words): Explain the design decisions you made, with specific reference to: (1) your target audience and why you chose them, (2) the persuasion technique you used and the evidence that it is appropriate for that group, (3) how your campaign addresses a social determinant from your HPE unit, and (4) how it differs from existing campaigns in a meaningful way.

Source 1 (URL): _____

Source 2 (URL): _____

Source 3 (URL): _____

Reflection — What Did You Learn?

2 marks

What is the most important thing you understand about health communication now that you did not understand before this unit?

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

How will you evaluate whether your campaign was effective — what would success look like?

🎯 Assessment Summary — Cross-Curricular Unit

HPE Assessment Component

Evidence that the student can identify and critique the accessibility and effectiveness of community support services and health strategies (VC2HP10P08). Assessed through: campaign brief, target audience analysis, use of Victorian data, social determinant connection, and justification.

English / Media Component

Evidence that the student can analyse text structures and language features (AAPPC analysis), evaluate source credibility, and create a sustained, purposeful text for a specific audience. Assessed through: campaign analyses, visual analysis, and final product + justification.

A-Standard Indicators

Sophisticated AAPPC analysis that goes beyond description to evaluation. Campaign brief shows nuanced audience understanding. Justification explicitly connects persuasion theory to social determinant evidence. Final product is genuinely tailored to a specific at-risk group, not a generic audience.

Suggested Marking

AAPPC Analysis ×2 — 12 marks (6 each)
Visual Language Analysis — 5 marks
Campaign Brief + Peer Review — 6 marks
Final Product + Justification — 12 marks
Reflection — 2 marks
Total — 37 marks

Advanced Water Safety — Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit · Year 9–10 HPE + English/Media · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · VC2HP10P02, VC2HP10P08, VC2HP10P09, VC2E9LY05, VC2E9LY08

lsv.com.au · sls.com.au · rlss.org.uk · victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au

© 2026 Emilie Harrison · CC BY 4.0 · emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety · Third-party content excluded

© 2026 Emilie Harrison. This resource is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0). You are free to copy, share, adapt and build on it — including for commercial purposes — provided you give appropriate credit and indicate any changes.

Suggested attribution: "Swim & Water Safety Teaching Hub" by Emilie Harrison, licensed CC BY 4.0. Source: emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety

Third-party material is not covered. Content owned by Life Saving Victoria, Royal Life Saving Australia, Surf Life Saving Australia, VCAA, ACARA, AIATSIS, the Australian Resuscitation Council and other organisations — including data, guidelines, logos and program names — remains the property of those owners and is used here for educational purposes. Check directly with the owner before reproducing it elsewhere.

Data sources cited in this resource. Drowning statistics are reproduced with attribution from: Life Saving Victoria. (2025). *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25*. Life Saving Victoria: Melbourne. Royal Life Saving Australia (2026). *National Drowning Report 2026*. RLSSA: Sydney. World Health Organization (2024). *Drowning — fact sheet*. WHO: Geneva. Surf Life Saving Australia (2026). *Summer Coastal Drowning Report 2025/26*. SLSA: Sydney. These figures remain the property of the publishing organisations. If you adapt this resource, retain these citations.